

Day one, a stale README.

New hires wait. Seniors repeat themselves. Every hire, from scratch.

 Slow

 Expensive

 Inconsistent

THE PROBLEM, MEASURED

This isn't a hunch.

58%

of a developer's time goes to understanding
existing code, not writing it

Xia et al., IEEE TSE 2018 • 79 devs, 3,244 hrs

82%

say the hardest part is knowing *why* the code is
the way it is

LaToza et al., ICSE 2006, Microsoft

AND THE FIXES DON'T SCALE

Docs go stale. Mentors get interrupted.



AI-only tours don't fix it either — 57% comprehension vs 83% with a human curator.

LACY — industry deployment, Beko (arXiv 2603.25391)

THE SOLUTION

One command inside Bob IDE.



Personalized

By role, experience, and start date



Grounded in code

Every claim cites a real file and line



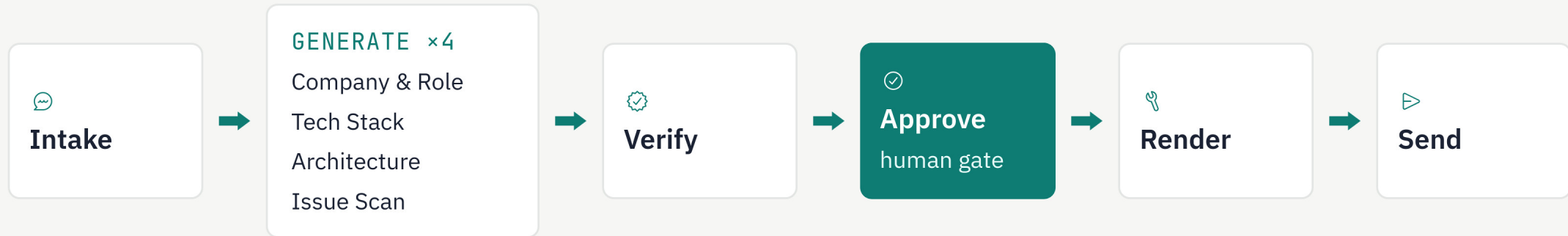
Never self-graded

Deterministic checks, then a human

```
▶ /onboard @instances/northwind-labs/instance.yaml
```

THE PIPELINE

Six stages. One human gate.



Nothing renders or sends until a person approves.

Point it at a codebase.

Stage 0 – Intake · Batch A

I have the pre-fill from `hires/alex-tan.yaml`. I need to ask about the project-specific fields that aren't in that file:

Batch A – Project details

The hire file gives us: Alex Tan, Backend Engineer, start 2026-10-05, junior, manager Priya Menon, buddy Daniel Wong.

Three things still needed:

1. **Target codebase path** – the absolute path to the repo Bob should scan (read-only). Which repo should be used?
2. **Company info** – the fictional company is *Northwind Labs* (handbook at `company/handbook.md`). Should I use that, or a different company?
3. **Max issues** to report (default 10), and should I **include a narrated tour video** with the PDF? (default: yes)

Use the built-in fixture repo at `scripts/fixtures/repo` as the target codebase; use Northwind Labs (`company/handbook.md`); 10 issues; include video

Use the built-in fixture repo at `scripts/fixtures/repo`; use Northwind Labs; 10 issues; NO video

Point to a different real repo on this machine (I'll provide the path); use Northwind Labs; 10 issues; include video

Four subagents. Real issues.

Explored 12 files : 12s >

10 issues found

I now have enough code evidence to run all 4 subagents in parallel. Launching them now:

Write two markdown files for the CTMS_Project onboarding pipeline (junior Backend Engineer Alex Tan at Northwind Labs). OU...

Running · 14 tools · 22.1k · 0.241 · 22s

Write bob-onboarding-workspace/onboarding/alex-tan/context/tech-stack.md for the CTMS_Project onboarding. CODEBASE F...

Running · 1 tool · 12.4k · 0.025 · 22s

Write bob-onboarding-workspace/onboarding/alex-tan/context/architecture.md for the CTMS_Project (a Cinema Ticket Manag...

Running · 1 tool · 13.0k · 0.026 · 22s

Write issue files for the CTMS_Project onboarding pipeline. Output directory: bob-onboarding-workspace/onboarding/alex-tan...

Running · 1 tool · 14.5k · 0.029 · 22s

LIVE — STAGE 4 Human approval

A person has to say yes.

try running the bob-onboarding-workspace pipeline159.0k / 270.0k15.57 X

Stage 5 Human approval (hard stop)6/11

ISSUE-007	Duplicate Servlet Declarations in web.xml	medium	maintainability	web.xml:4-7, :133-147	→ 2026-10-19
ISSUE-008	AuthFilter Null Session Attribute Bug	medium	bug	AuthFilter.java:41-50	2026-10-19 → 2026-11-03
ISSUE-009	Customer Password Exposed in Session	medium	security	Customer.java:14-21	2026-10-19 → 2026-11-03
ISSUE-010	No Input Validation or Output Encoding	medium	security	web/register.jsp	2026-11-04 → 2026-11-17

The full video script is in `onboarding/alex-tan/storyboard.json`. I can show its narration if you'd like to review it before approving.

Do you approve this onboarding pack to proceed to PDF render, video render, and email?

Approved — proceed with all stages (PDF, video, zip, dry-run email)

Approved — skip video, just do PDF + zip + dry-run email

Show me the video script narration first before deciding

Make a correction first (I'll describe what to change)

23 files changedUndo allShow all

Follow up, ⌘ to steer, Alt ⌘ to queue, esc to cancel

+ AgentPermissions

Autocomplete (0)

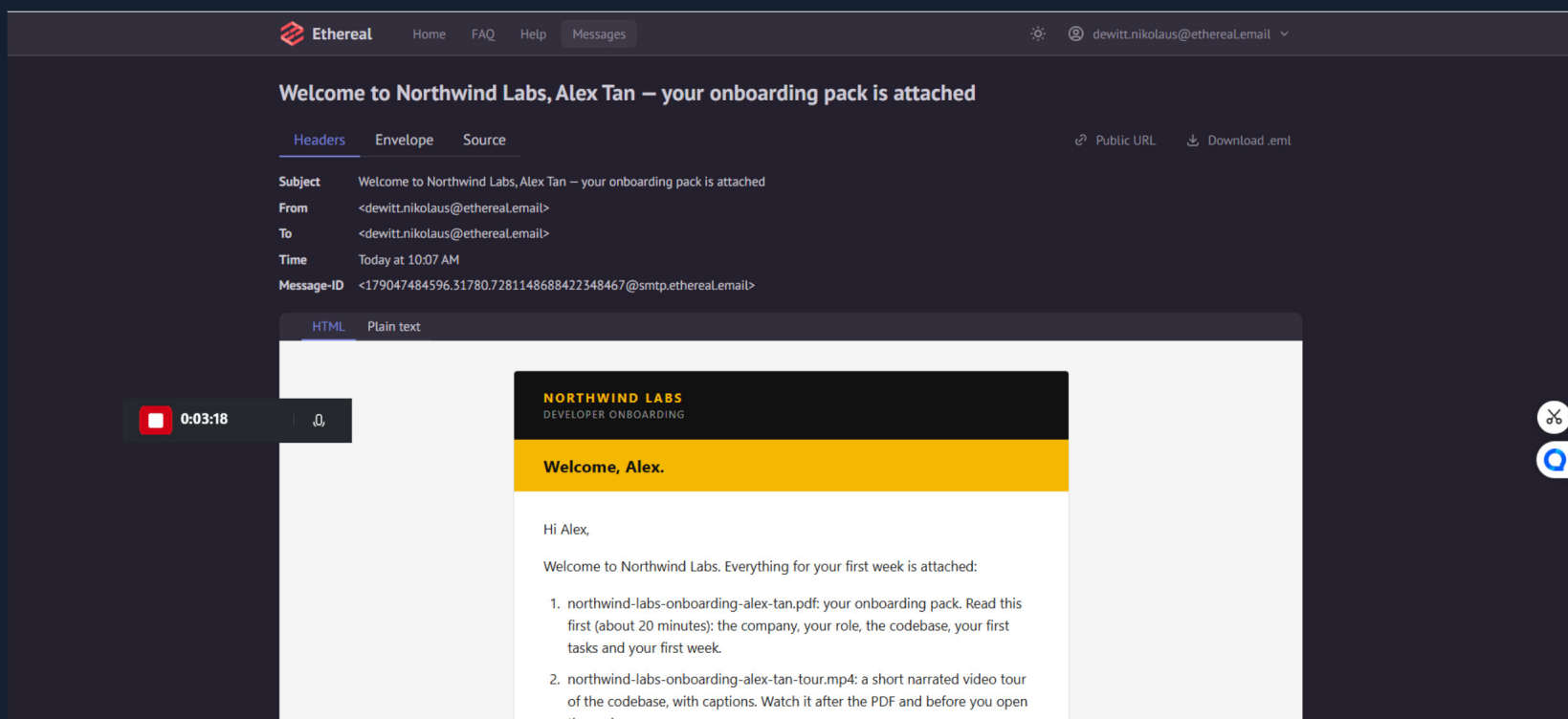
LIVE — STAGE 5 Render

PDF, video, context — rendered.

The screenshot displays a VS Code editor window with the following components:

- Explorer Sidebar:** Shows the file tree for 'ASKS_CTTB_SYSTEM-MAIN'. The file 'northwind-labs-onboarding-alex-tan.pdf' is selected.
- Main Editor:** Displays the PDF content. The table of contents lists sections 06 through 13. The main content area shows four sections: 'YOU' (Alex Tan, Backend Engineer), 'DAY' (Timeline from 2026-10-05 to 2027-01-03), 'YOUR PEOPLE' (Manager: Priya Menon, Buddy: Daniel Wong), and 'START HERE' (Instructions for setting up the IDE and following the timeline).
- Output/Console Panel:** Shows the 'try running...' output, indicating the stage 6b render video is optional and 8/11 scenes to 4 nodes.

Delivered — with proof.



Built with Bob, end to end.



A Bob skill, not a script

/onboard runs the pipeline; /build-pipeline rebuilds the workspace itself



Agent mode, end to end

Four subagents generate in parallel under one Bob task



Bob built its own tool

It wrote the email MCP server, and ran its own fix loop on failures



Every run, logged

Task summaries screenshotted in bob_sessions/ for this exact run

IMPACT

~20 min

machine time, this run

vs.

20–40
hrs

expert time per hire, industry baseline

LACY – Beko pre-study survey (arXiv 2603.25391)

Plus about one minute of human approval. The narrated video is the slowest stage — and it's optional.

A generic core.
A folder per client.
A human in control.

One proof-of-concept hire so far. The pipeline itself is generic — a new client is a folder, and Bob rebuilds the workspace from its own spec.